# SoundSFXPaste

## User manual

Free sound-effects panel for DaVinci Resolve Studio on Mac

Version 0.2.0 · https://gordas.dev/soundsfxpaste/
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# 1. What it solves, and your first 5-minute exercise

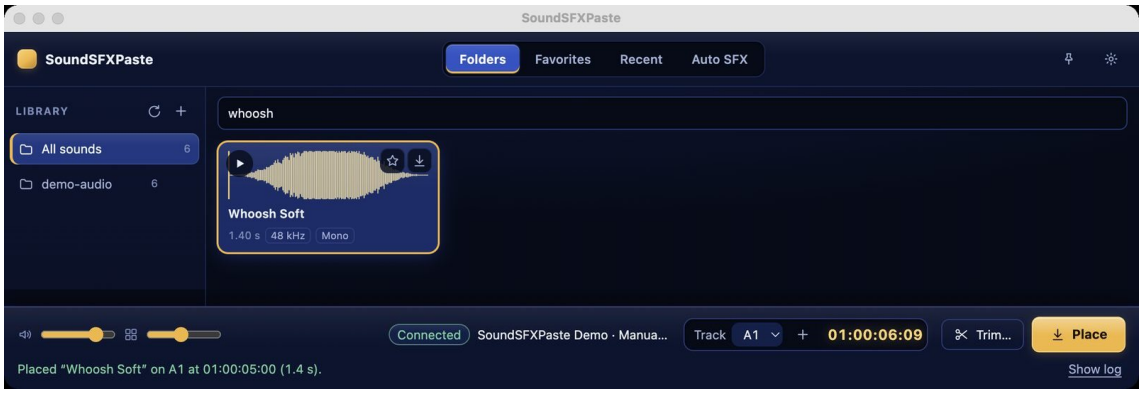
SoundSFXPaste is a DaVinci Resolve Studio panel that keeps your sound-effects library at hand: search, see the waveform, audition, and place the sound straight onto an audio track at the cursor, without dragging files from Finder or hunting in the Media Pool. The panel sits next to the timeline (it can stay on top) and talks to Resolve through a small local helper.

Besides simple placing, the panel does four things you do often when adding sound: trim a sound before placing it, replace sounds already on the timeline, manage markers (names, tags), and fill markers with sounds, randomly or one by one.

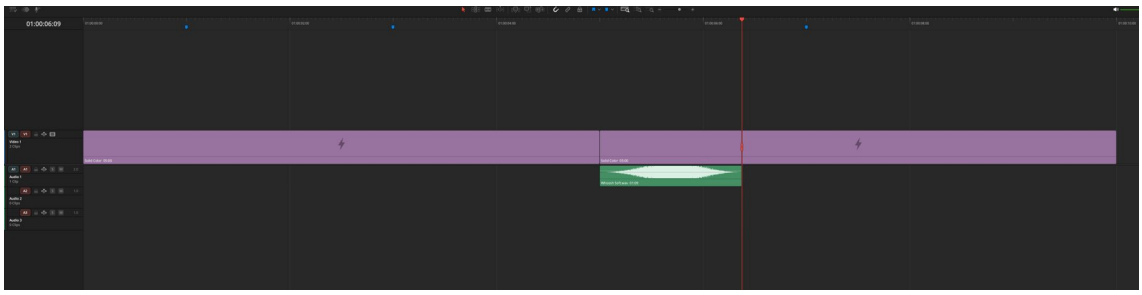
## The 5-minute exercise

Use the project's **demo-audio** folder (six synthesized, rights-free sounds) and an empty timeline with at least one audio track. Goal: a 1.4 s whoosh exactly on the cut between two video clips.

1. In Resolve: **Workspace › Workflow Integrations › SoundSFXPaste**. The panel window opens.
2. Press **Add folder** (+ in **Library**) and choose the **demo-audio** folder. Six cards with waveforms appear.
3. Type “whoosh” in the **Search sounds** field and click the **Whoosh Soft** card.
4. In Resolve, park the cursor (playhead) on the cut: **01:00:05:00**.
5. In the panel, leave **Track** on **A1** and press **Place**.
6. Check: the green message at the bottom and a new clip on A1 starting at 01:00:05:00.




*After **Place**: the confirmation message and the cursor moved to the end of the clip.*



*The timeline: the “Whoosh Soft” clip on A1, starting exactly at the video cut.*

**If you made a mistake:** in Resolve press **Cmd+Z** (one placement = one undo step) or select the clip and delete it. The panel never touches the source file.

# 2. Installation and requirements

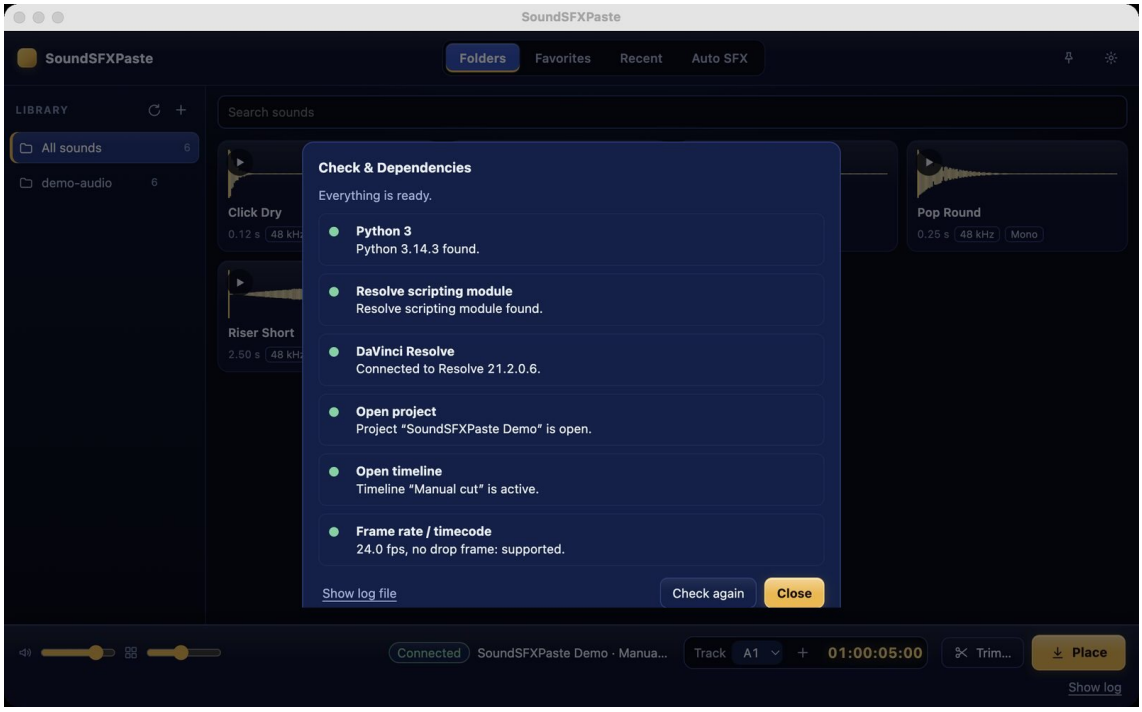
The official package is a signed **SoundSFXPaste-0.2.0.pkg**, from the project page or the latest GitHub release. Download it, double-click it and follow the installer (accept the license; macOS asks for your password because the panel installs into Resolve's shared plugin folder).

```
/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Workflow Integration Plugins/SoundSFXPaste
```

| | |
|---|---|
| **DaVinci Resolve Studio** | Required. Workflow Integration panels do not run in the free version. Verified with Resolve Studio 21.2. |
| **Python 3 (3.8 or newer)** | Required for the local helper that talks to Resolve. Install it from python.org if missing; see the Troubleshooting chapter. |
| **External scripting: Local** | In Resolve: Preferences › General › External scripting using: **Local**. |
| **Non-drop-frame timeline** | Placing is refused on drop-frame timelines (see Troubleshooting). |

### Checking dependencies

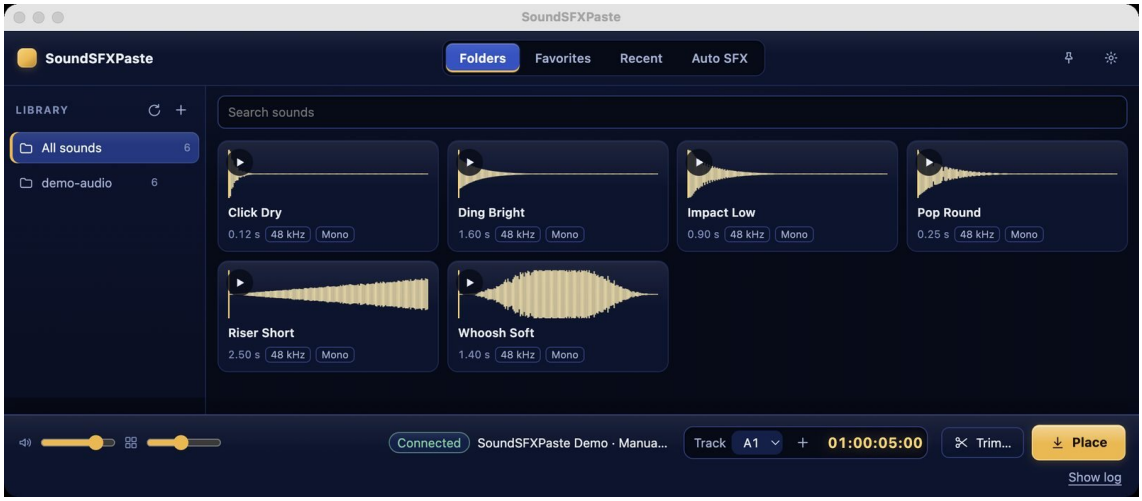
Open **Settings** (the gear at the top) and press **Check & dependencies**. The panel lists Python 3, the Resolve scripting module, Resolve, the open project, the active timeline and the frame rate, each with a green or red dot and, if red, the fix. After fixing something, press **Check again**.




*Check & dependencies: all green means placing will work.*

# 3. The interface at a glance

Open the panel from **Workspace › Workflow Integrations › SoundSFXPaste**. Besides the four tabs, it has a bottom bar with everything about the destination.




*The panel with the demo library loaded. Top: tabs; left: library; bottom: volume, density, track, cursor,* **Trim…** *and* **Place**.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Folders** | All the sounds in your folders, with search and waveforms. |
| **Favorites / Recent** | Starred sounds and the last ones you placed. |
| **Auto SFX** | Four routes: **Random Fill**, **Replace**, **Manage markers**, **Rapid Mapping**. |
| **Keep on top** | The pin button at the top keeps the panel above the Resolve window. |
| **Track and cursor** | The target track (A1, A2…), the + button (**Add track**) and, in yellow, the Resolve cursor's timecode: that is where the sound lands. |
| **Trim… / Place** | Trim before placing; place the chosen sound at the cursor. |

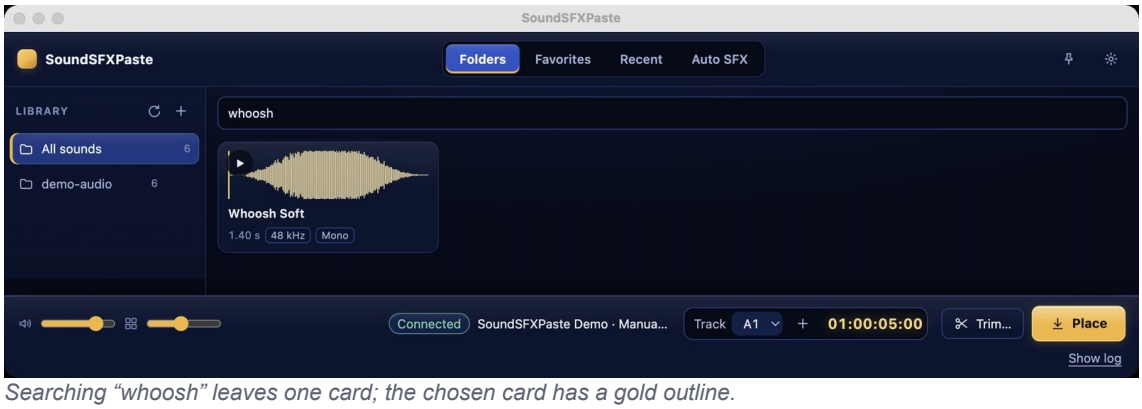
# 4. Folders, search, waveforms and audition

## Adding and removing folders

**Add folder** picks a folder; the panel reads it recursively (hidden folders are skipped) and lists the sounds under **All sounds**. Each folder shows in the **Library** column with its sound count; the remove button (**Remove folder from library**) drops it from the library without touching any file. **Refresh** rereads the folders after you add new files.

## Search

The **Search sounds** field filters as you type, by file name. If nothing matches you see “No sounds match.”. Clear the text to see everything again.




*Searching “whoosh” leaves one card; the chosen card has a gold outline.*

### Waveform, audition and volume

Each card shows the waveform, length, sample rate and channels. The ► button on the card (**Audition**) plays the sound inside the panel, at the volume set in the bottom bar (**Audition volume**); press again to stop. It is a local audition, so the sound comes out of the Mac's audio output, not from Resolve. With **Preview on hover** in **Settings**, the sound starts when you rest the mouse on a card. The second slider in the bottom bar (**Grid density**) makes the cards larger or smaller.

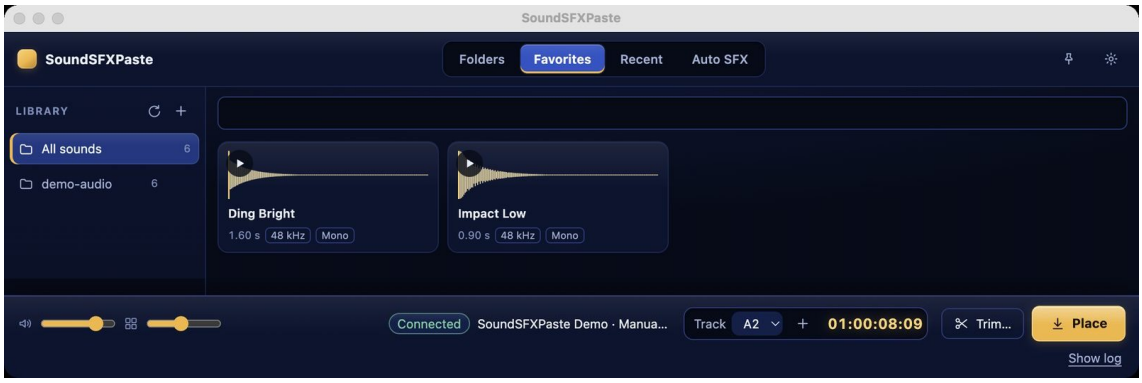
### ► Audition before you choose

| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | Listen to Whoosh Soft and Ding Bright and decide which fits. |
| **Where to click** | Press ► on each card (top-left corner of the card). |
| **What should appear** | The playing card shows an indicator; the sound is heard on the Mac's output and nothing changes in the timeline. |
| **How to undo** | Press ► again or pick another sound; auditioning changes nothing. |

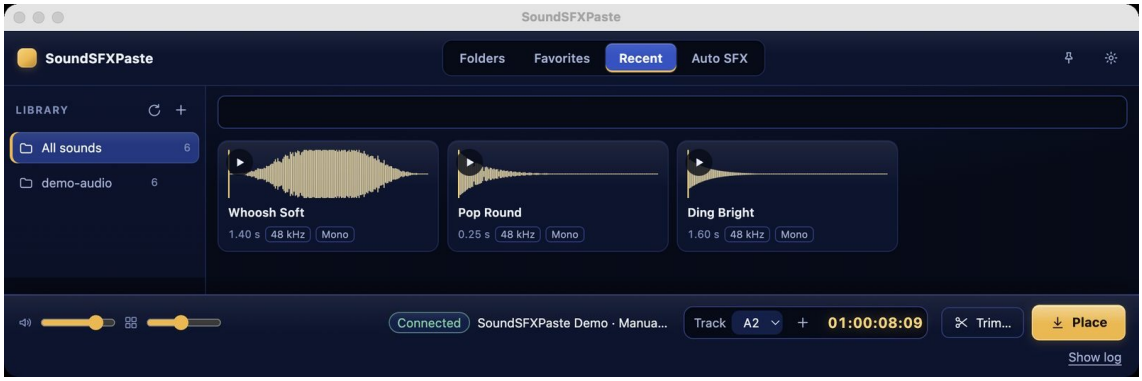
The waveform cache keeps this fast: **Clear waveform cache** in **Settings** empties it. A file that cannot be decoded shows “This file could not be decoded for preview.”.

## 5. Favorites, Recent, language and Keep on top

The star on a card (**Favorite**) moves the sound into the **Favorites** tab; press it again to remove it. The **Recent** tab keeps the sounds you placed, newest first. Both lists persist between sessions.



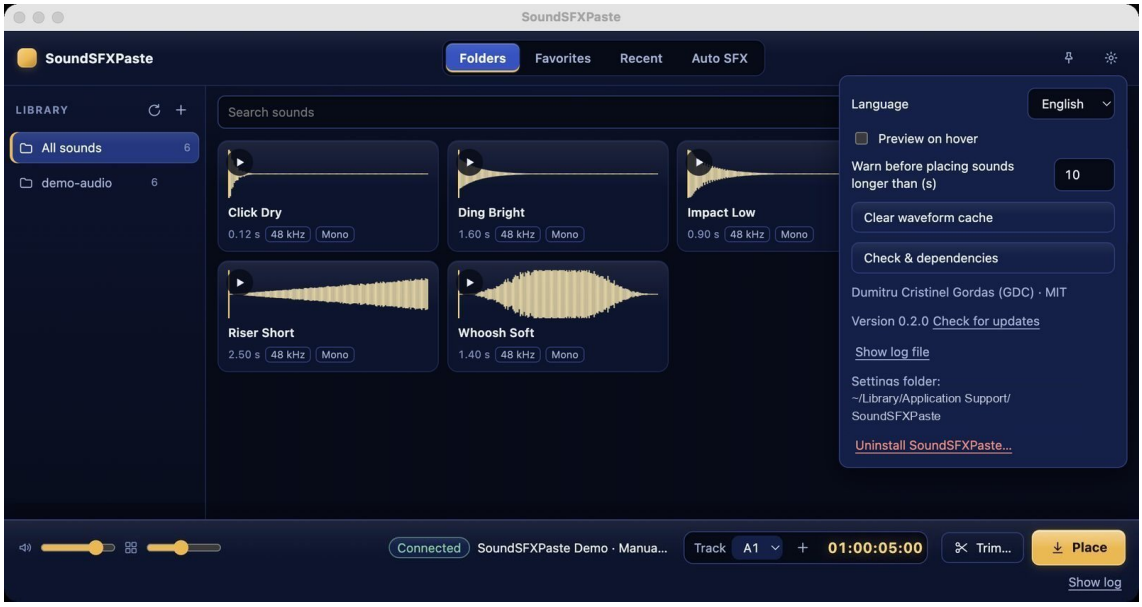

*The **Favorites** tab with two starred sounds.*




*The **Recent** tab: the last sounds placed.*

### Panel language

In **Settings**, under **Language**, choose Romanian, English or Spanish. The change applies immediately; messages already on screen stay in the language they appeared in.




*Settings: language, preview on hover, long-sound warning, cache clearing, dependency check, version and uninstall.*

### Keep on top

The pin button (**Keep on top**) keeps the panel above the Resolve window so it does not vanish when you click in the timeline. Press it again to release it. The setting is remembered.

## 6. Placing: the track, the cursor, an exact frame

The sound lands on the track chosen in **Track**, at the Resolve cursor position (the yellow timecode in the bottom bar). The order never changes: choose the sound, choose the track, park the cursor where you want it, press **Place** (or the **Place at cursor** button on the card).

### Choosing the track

The **Track** menu lists the timeline's audio tracks; locked tracks are marked (**locked**). **Add track** (the + button) adds a new track. If the chosen track already has a clip at that spot, the placement is refused, not overlapped (see Troubleshooting).

### Position: cursor or exact frame

The position is the Resolve cursor. For an exact frame, type the timecode in Resolve (the timeline's timecode field) or step the cursor with the arrow keys, then check the yellow value in the panel before **Place**. After placing, the cursor jumps to the end of the new clip, so you can lay sounds one after another.

### ► A whoosh exactly on a cut

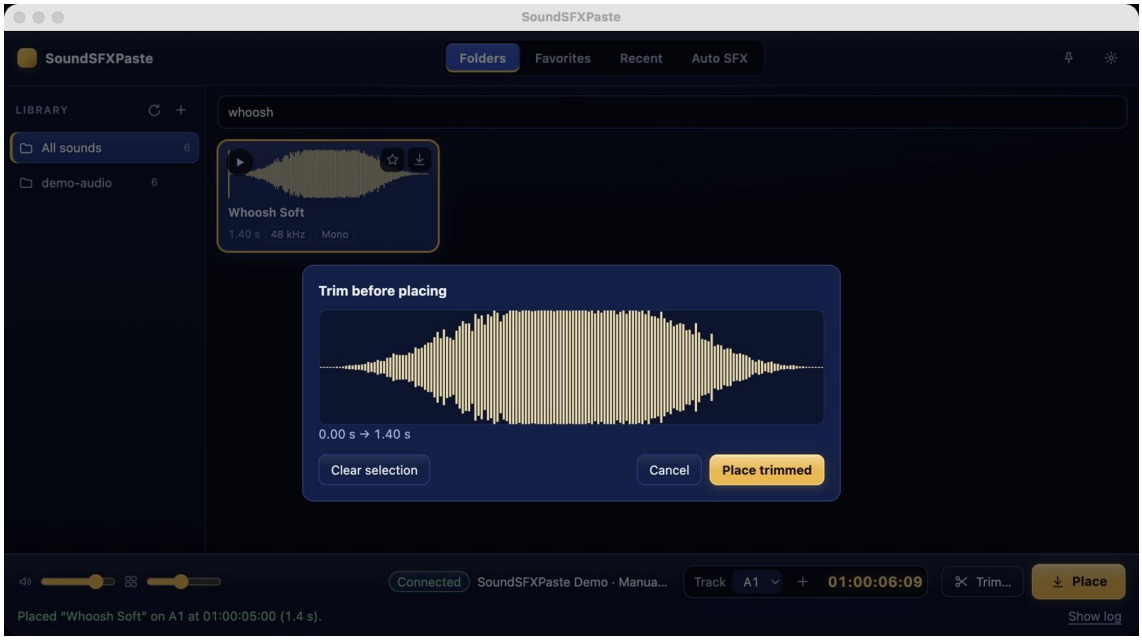
| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | Whoosh Soft (1.4 s) on A1, starting at the video cut 01:00:05:00. |
| **Where to click** | Select the Whoosh Soft card; in Resolve park the cursor on 01:00:05:00; in the panel check **Track** = A1; press **Place**. |
| **What should appear** | Green message: “Whoosh Soft” placed on A1 at 01:00:05:00 (1.4 s); a new clip on A1; the cursor jumps to 01:00:06:09 (33 frames at 24 fps). |
| **How to undo** | Cmd+Z in Resolve, or delete the clip. If it went on the wrong track, undo and repeat with another track. |

### Verified placement, not assumed

The panel plans the placement, writes it to Resolve and **verifies** it afterwards; if the result differs from the plan it rolls back and shows an error (Resolve placed it differently than planned. Check the timeline.). A sound longer than the limit in **Warn before placing sounds longer than (s)** needs a second press of **Place** to confirm. Dragging a card straight into the timeline exists in the code but is **not verified** in this version: use the buttons.

# 7. Trimming a sound (Trim…)

**Trim…** opens “Trim before placing”: the chosen sound's waveform, on which you drag a range. Only that portion reaches the timeline; the file stays untouched. Under the waveform you see the range in seconds.




*The trim dialog: the waveform and, under it, the chosen range.*

### ► Only the middle of a riser

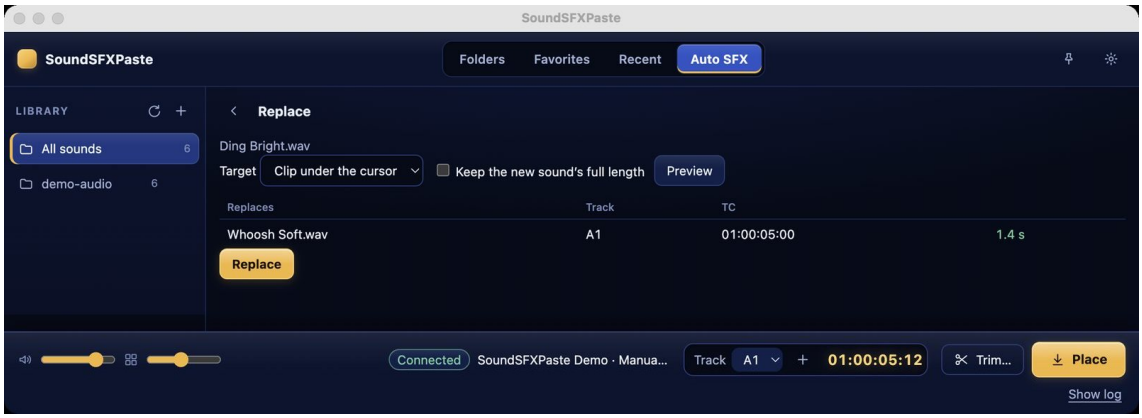
| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | From Riser Short (2.5 s) place only the second between 0.8 s and 1.8 s, at 01:00:03:00 on A1. |
| **Where to click** | Select Riser Short; Resolve cursor on 01:00:03:00; press **Trim…**; drag on the waveform from 0.8 s to 1.8 s; check the numbers under the wave; press **Place trimmed**. |
| **What should appear** | A short clip on A1 at 01:00:03:00, as long as the chosen range (the cursor jumps to its end). |
| **How to undo** | **Clear selection** clears the range so you can drag another; **Cancel** (or Esc) closes without placing; after placing, Cmd+Z in Resolve. |

Always check the numbers under the waveform before **Place trimmed**: they are the range that will be placed. A click without dragging does not create a range.

# 8. Replacing a sound (Replace)

The **Replace** route in **Auto SFX** swaps clips already on the timeline for the sound chosen in the library, keeping the position. Choose the new sound first (the **Folders** tab), then go to **Auto SFX** › **Replace**. Under **Target** pick what gets replaced: **Selected clips** (the clips selected in Resolve) or **Clip under the cursor**. The **Keep the new sound's full length** checkbox keeps the new sound's whole length instead of the old clip's length.

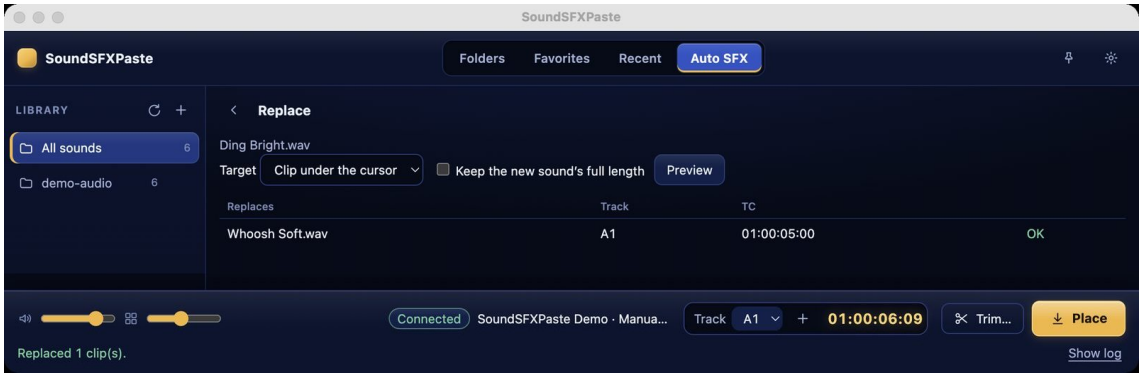
Always press **Preview** first: the table shows which clip gets replaced, on which track, at what timecode and how long, with "OK" or the reason it is refused. Only then press **Replace**.



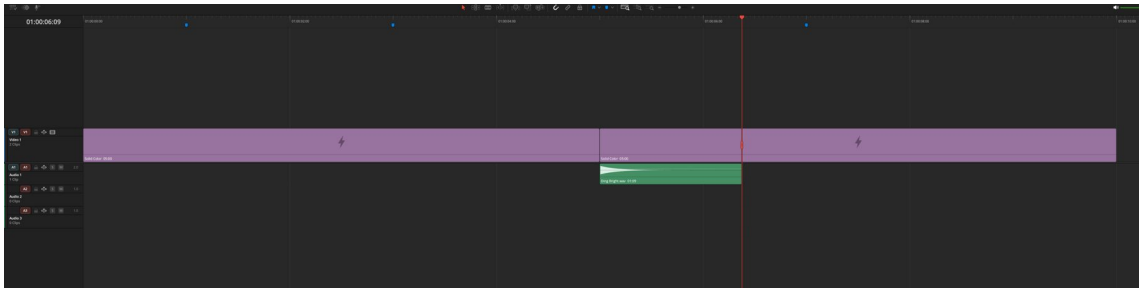

*The preview: Whoosh Soft on A1 at 01:00:05:00 will be replaced.*

## ► Swap a sound keeping its position

| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | Replace the Whoosh Soft at the cut with Ding Bright, on the same track and at the same timecode. |
| **Where to click** | Park the Resolve cursor on the clip (e.g. 01:00:05:12); in **Folders** pick Ding Bright; in **Auto SFX** › **Replace** set **Target** = **Clip under the cursor**; press **Preview**, read the table, then **Replace**. |
| **What should appear** | The message "Replaced 1 clip(s).”; on A1 at 01:00:05:00 the clip is now named Ding Bright. |
| **How to undo** | Cmd+Z in Resolve brings back the old clip. If the preview table is not what you want, do not press **Replace**: change **Target** or move the cursor. |



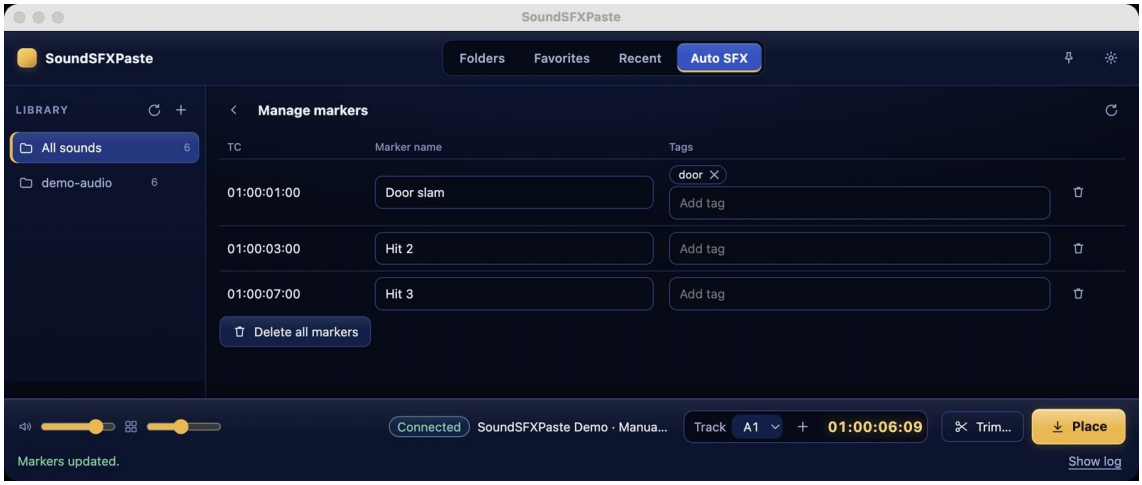

*After* **Replace** *the table stays and the message confirms.*



*The timeline: the replaced clip, in the same place.*

# 9. Markers and tags (Manage markers)

**Manage markers** lists the timeline's markers with timecode, name and tags. The **Marker name** field renames the marker (saved when you leave the field), and in **Tags** you type a tag and press Enter (**Add tag**); each tag shows as a bubble with × to remove it. The bin on a row deletes the marker (**Delete marker**); **Delete all markers** deletes them all, after a confirmation (Yes, delete all). The reload button in the corner rereads the markers.



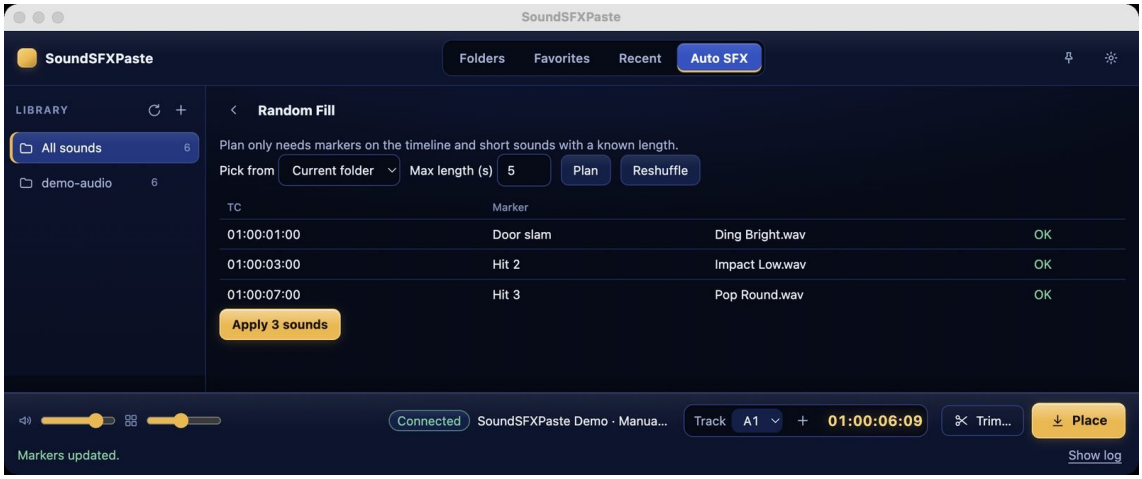

*The timeline's markers: the first renamed “Door slam” and tagged “door”.*

## ► Prepare markers before filling

| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | On a timeline with three markers (Hit 1/2/3 at 01:00:01:00, 01:00:03:00, 01:00:07:00) give the first one a clear name and a tag. |
| **Where to click** | **Auto SFX** › **Manage markers**; on the first row type “Door slam” in **Marker name** and press Tab; in **Tags** type “door” and press Enter. |
| **What should appear** | The message “Markers updated.”; the row shows the new name and the “door” bubble; the timeline marker has the new name. |
| **How to undo** | Retype the name, or press × on the tag. Deleting a marker cannot be undone from the panel: use Cmd+Z in Resolve right after. |

# 10. Random fill (Random Fill)

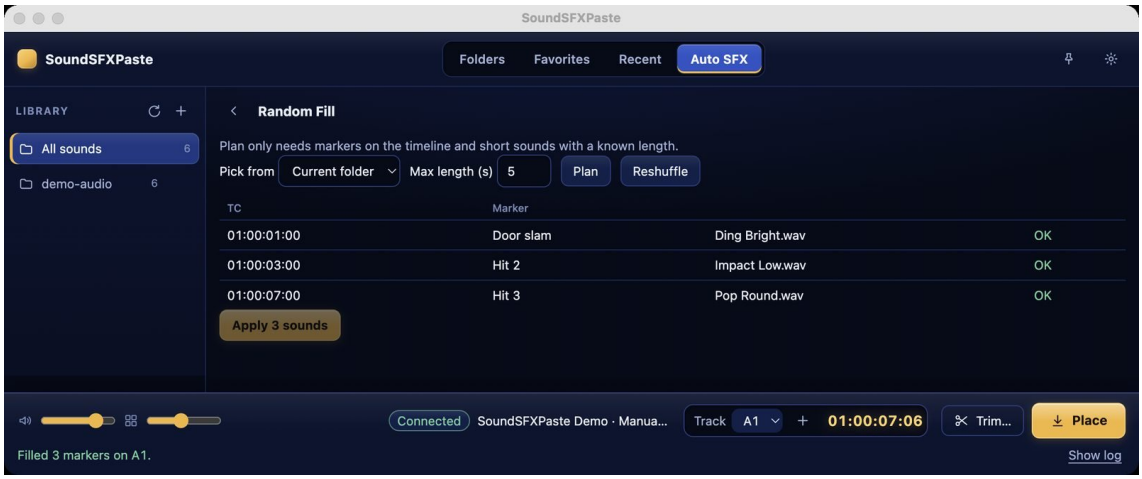
**Random Fill** puts a randomly chosen short sound on every marker of the timeline. **Pick from** sets the source (**Current folder** or **Favorites**); **Max length (s)** drops sounds longer than the limit. **Plan** shows the plan without writing anything; **Reshuffle** draws different sounds; **Apply 3 sounds** writes the plan to the track chosen in the bottom bar.



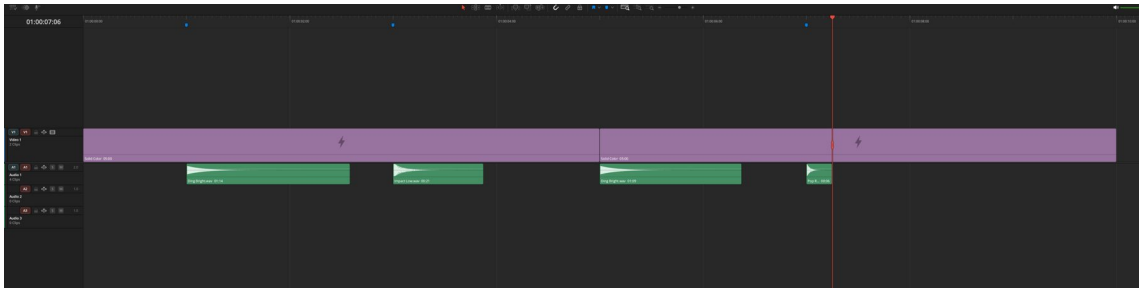

*The plan: three markers, three sounds, all “OK”.*

## ► Fill three markers in one go

| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | A short sound (max 5 s) on each of the three markers, on A1. |
| **Where to click** | Track A1 in the bottom bar; **Auto SFX** › **Random Fill**; **Pick from** = **Current folder**; **Max length (s)** = 5; press **Plan**; if you do not like it, **Reshuffle**; then **Apply 3 sounds**. |
| **What should appear** | The message “Filled 3 markers on A1” and three clips on A1, one at each marker. |
| **How to undo** | Cmd+Z three times in Resolve (one step per clip) or select the three clips and delete them. A different result comes from **Reshuffle** before applying. |




*After applying, the plan stays visible.*

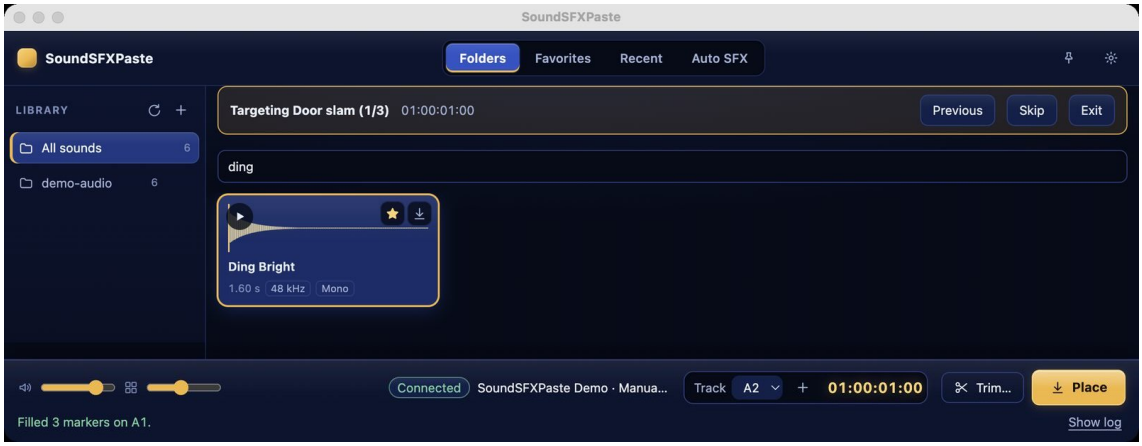


*The timeline: one clip at each marker.*

With a small **Max length (s)** and dense markers, check **Plan** first: “No sounds in this source are short enough (or their length is not known yet).” means no sound in the chosen source is short enough.

# 11. Rapid mapping (Rapid Mapping)

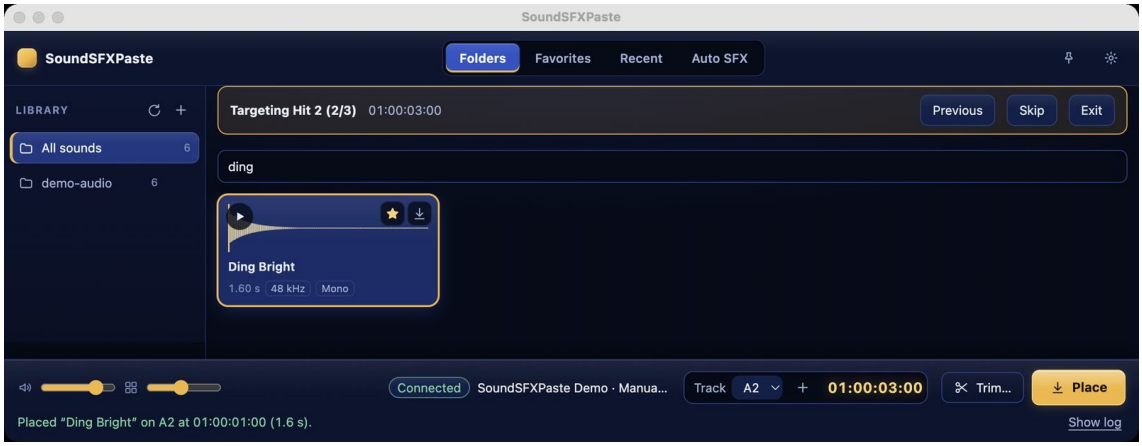
**Rapid Mapping** steps through the markers one at a time: you pick a sound, it is placed on the current marker, and the cursor jumps to the next. Press **Start mapping**; the bar at the top shows the current marker (“Targeting … (1/3)”) with the **Previous**, **Skip** and **Exit** buttons. Go to the **Folders** tab, choose a card and press **Place**. At the end you get “All 3 markers visited.”.



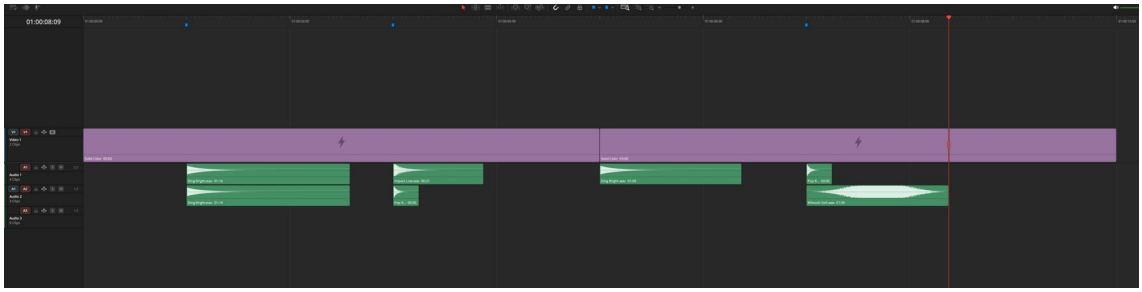

*Mapping started: target “Door slam (1/3)” at 01:00:01:00.*

## ► A sound on each marker, your choice

| | |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | Ding Bright on the first marker, Impact Low on the second, Whoosh Soft on the third, on track A2. |
| **Where to click** | Choose track A2; **Auto SFX** › **Rapid Mapping** › **Start mapping**; in **Folders** click a card, then **Place**; repeat for each marker; **Skip** jumps over one. |
| **What should appear** | After each **Place**, the message “Placed … on A2 at 01:00:01:00” and the target moves to the next marker; at the end “All 3 markers visited”. |
| **How to undo** | **Previous** goes back to the previous marker to place again; **Exit** stops mapping. A wrong clip is undone with Cmd+Z in Resolve. |




*After the first placement the target is “Hit 2 (2/3)”.*



*The timeline: sounds on A2, at the markers.*

If a placement is refused (busy track), the target stays on the same marker: change the track or skip.

# 12. Troubleshooting from real situations

| | |
|---|---|
| **Busy or locked track** | Messages: “the track already has a clip there. Pick another track or position.” / “the track is locked. Unlock it in Resolve.”. Pick another track or position, or unlock the track in Resolve (the padlock in the track header). The panel never overlaps clips. |
| **Resolve refuses the placement** | Messages: “Resolve did not place the sound. Check the track and position in the panel, then try again.” or “Resolve refused the change.”. Check the track and position in the panel, then try again; if it repeats, open **Show log file** and check whether the active timeline changed (“the active project or timeline changed. Nothing was written.”: nothing was written). On “Resolve placed it differently than planned. Check the timeline.” the placement was rolled back: check the timeline. |
| **The panel does not connect** | The indicator shows “Not connected” or “DaVinci Resolve is not reachable. In Resolve: Preferences › General › External scripting using: Local.” appears. In Resolve: Preferences › General › External scripting using: **Local**; then **Settings** › **Check & dependencies** › **Check again**. Also check that a project and a timeline are open. |
| **Python is not found** | Messages: “The helper process stopped. Is Python 3 installed?” / “The helper process did not start. Is Python 3 installed?”, and in **Check & dependencies** Python 3 is red. Install Python 3 (3.8+) from python.org and reopen the panel. If it is installed somewhere unusual, set “pythonPath” in the settings file (its location is in **Settings**). |
| **A drop-frame timeline is refused** | Message: “drop-frame timelines are not supported yet.”. With drop-frame, the timecode skips numbers, so a frame position no longer maps to a plain timecode; the panel blocks placing so no clip lands in the wrong spot. Use a non-drop-frame timeline (for example 24 or 25 fps). |
| **A file outside the library** | “that file is outside your library folders.”: the panel reads only from the folders you added. Add the folder with **Add folder**. |
| **Empty library or no results** | “Add a folder with sound effects to begin.” means no folder was added; “No sounds match.” means the **Search sounds** filter finds nothing. Common formats such as WAV, AIFF, MP3, FLAC and M4A are read. |

For any other error, **Show log file** (in **Settings**) opens the log; it does not contain the audio files' content.

# 13. Updating and uninstalling

## Updating

In **Settings**, next to the version number, press **Check for updates**. The possible results: “You are up to date.”, “Version x.y.z is available.” with the **Update now** / **Later** buttons, or a check error with the reason. **Update now** downloads the package, verifies its signature and installs it; macOS shows its native administrator-password prompt. At the end: “Updated. Close and reopen the panel from Workflow Integrations.”. Close the panel and reopen it from Workflow Integrations.

### Uninstalling

In **Settings** press **Uninstall SoundSFXPaste…**. After confirmation the panel removes its folder, settings, cache and log; your audio files are not touched. If the panel folder needs administrator permission, the panel says the settings were removed and the folder goes away with your password. You can also do it by hand: quit Resolve and move the folder below to the Trash.

```
/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Workflow Integration Plugins/SoundSFXPaste
```

# 14. Compatibility and known limits

| | |
|---|---|
| **Verified** | DaVinci Resolve Studio 21.2 on macOS 27 (Apple Silicon); a 24 fps non-drop-frame timeline; placing, trimming, replacing, markers, random fill and rapid mapping; installation and update through the official channel. |
| **Not verified** | Dragging a card straight into the timeline; frame rates other than 24 fps; installing on a clean Mac with a quarantined file; Windows (a separate stage, not available yet). |
| **Not supported** | Drop-frame timelines (placing is refused, see Troubleshooting). The free version of Resolve does not load Workflow Integration panels. |

A clip's length is computed with the timeline frame rate. The panel is an independent, free project; it is not developed, endorsed or supported by Blackmagic Design.

# 15. Video tutorials

A series of short clips, without voice or overlaid text, filmed with the panel in Romanian, on the demo library. The titles stay in Romanian in every language. The clips are on the project page: gordas.dev/soundsfxpaste.

| Clip | Title | Manual chapter |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **„Deschide panoul și adaugă un folder de sunete”** | Chapters 3–4 |
| 2 | **„Caută, ascultă și plasează un sunet la cursor”** | Chapters 4 and 6 |
| 3 | **„Scurtează un sunet”** | Chapter 7 |
| 4 | **„Înlocuiește un sunet în timeline”** | Chapter 8 |
| 5 | **„Folosește markere și etichete”** | Chapter 9 |
| 6 | **„Completează markerele cu sunete aleatorii”** | Chapter 10 |
| 7 | **„Asociază rapid sunete cu markerele”** | Chapter 11 |

# 16. License, credits and third-party notices

SoundSFXPaste is free software under the MIT license. Author: Dumitru Cristinel Gordas (GDC). Source code: https://github.com/gordasgdc/soundsfxpaste. Support, if you wish to give it, is a voluntary donation; nothing is required to use the panel.

The panel runs in Resolve's own Electron window (Electron is not redistributed in this package). The sounds in the demo-audio folder are synthesized by the project and released into the public domain (CC0). Third-party notices are in the project's NOTICE.md file and on the package license page: NOTICE.md.

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